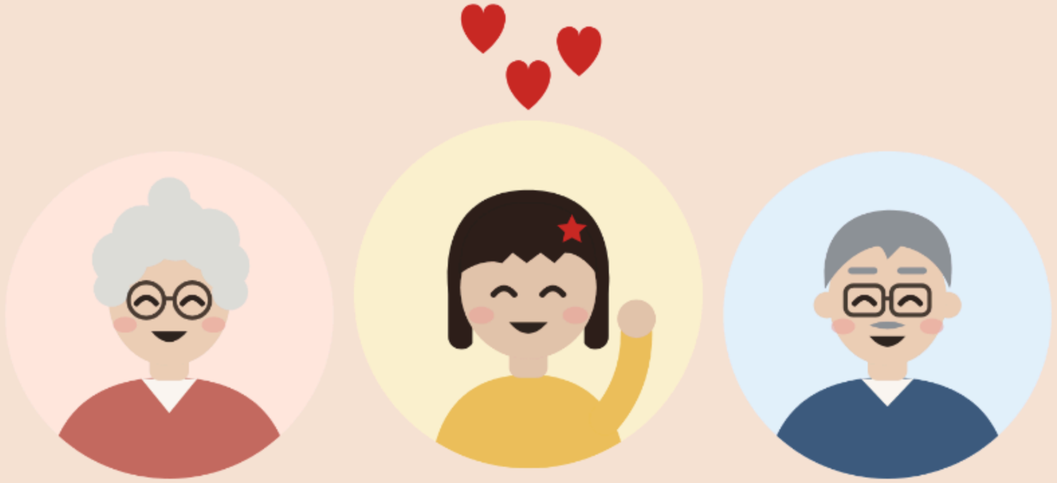
Thought

PAYPAL AI HACKATHON 2026



Thoughtful gifts from grandparents abroad.

Experiences for their grandkids in the US, paid with PayPal in their own currency.
AI suggests what fits. The kids say thank you on video.



It’s 9 p.m. in Taipei. Grandma Chang wants to give Mei something for her birthday. All she can send is a wire.

Last year: a wire transfer, fees nobody explained, and no idea where the money went.

What she wanted was simple: **for Mei to know Grandma was thinking of her.**

WHY IT MATTERS

Distance is lonely. Feeling close is what helps.

1 in 6

people worldwide are affected by loneliness. It's linked to about 871,000 deaths a year.

Closeness

lowered depressive symptoms for grandparents and adult grandchildren. More contact on its own didn't help.

WHO Commission on Social Connection, 2025 · Moorman & Stokes, The Gerontologist, 2016

WHO IT'S FOR

Almost half of California's kids have a parent born abroad.

44%

of California children have at least one immigrant parent.

35–42%

of residents are foreign-born in San Francisco, Alameda, San Mateo and Santa Clara counties.

41%

of California's 10.9 million immigrants were born in Asia.

Public Policy Institute of California, Immigrants in California, 2026 (2024 census data)

THE MONEY

Grandparents already give. Sending it abroad is costly and unclear.

$2,654

a year: what the average US grandparent spends on all their grandchildren.

14.99%

average cost when a bank sends $200 abroad. The global average is 6.36%.

9.98%

average cost to send money from Japan, up from 7.11% earlier in 2025.

AARP, The Essential Role of Grandparents, 2026 · World Bank, Remittance Prices Worldwide, Q3 2025

Give an experience, not a transfer.

Swim or art classes. A museum visit. A family dinner. A week of camp. The scooter she's been wishing for. Grandma's money becomes something Mei can do, and remember who gave it.

HOW IT WORKS

Three steps, three people, one gift.



STEP 1

Grandma picks a gift

Classes, outings, a family dinner, or something Mei is wishing for. In her language.

NT$ → US$

STEP 2

PayPal moves the money

She pays in her own currency. Every fee is shown, before and after.



STEP 3

Mei says thank you

A short video thank-you, translated for Grandma.

HOW IT WORKS, STEP BY STEP

Let me show you.

1 Pick who you are

2 Grandma's home, in Chinese

3 Choose an amount, see every fee

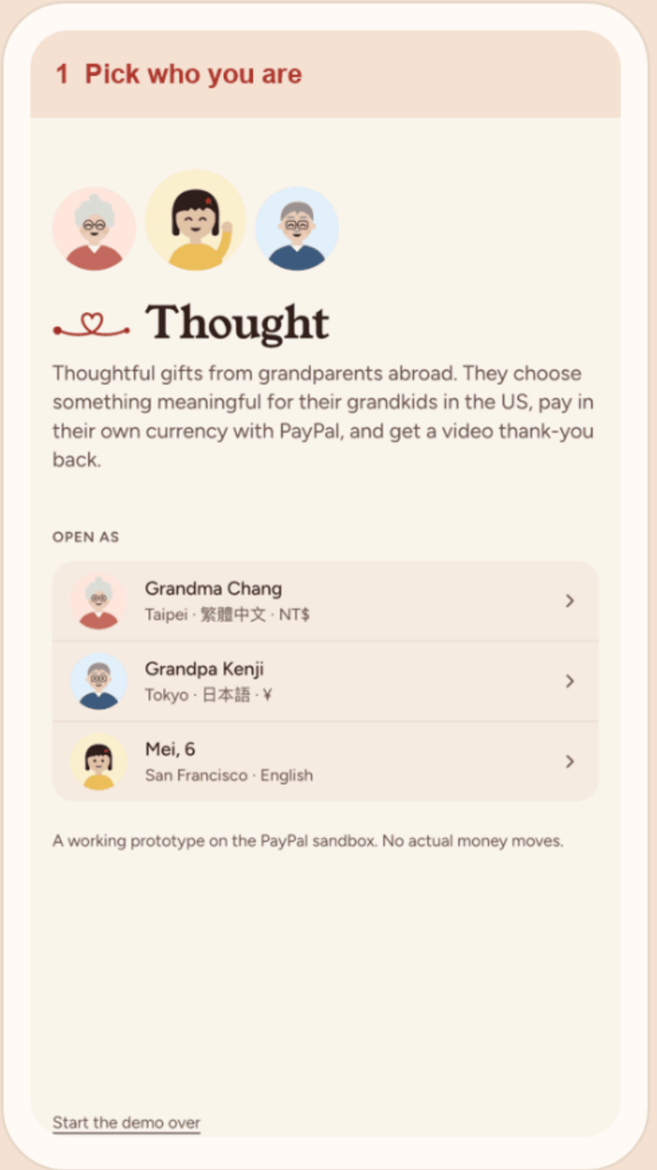
4 Pay with PayPal: actual fee and rate

5 Grandpa joins: given together

6 Mei sees one gift from both

7 Her thank-you arrives, translated

Live at thought-one.vercel.app, on the PayPal sandbox.



HOW IT'S BUILT

Three pieces, in plain words.

PAYPAL

PayPal moves the money

Grandma pays in her own currency, on PayPal. Thought reads back PayPal's actual fee and exchange rate, so her receipt is exact.

AI

AI helps, but never pays

Claude suggests gifts that fit Mei and translates her thank-you. Rules in our code check every suggestion. Only Grandma can pay.

THE APP

One web app, on any phone

Four languages, no download. Payments and videos are stored safely online.

PayPal Orders API · Claude Sonnet 5.5 via Vercel AI Gateway · Next.js and Vercel Blob on Vercel

DEMO · STEP 2 · PAYPAL

Two sandbox payments through PayPal. Our fee estimate matched both exactly.

PayPal sandbox	Grandma Chang · Taipei	Grandpa Kenji · Tokyo
Paid	NT$3,000	¥3,000
PayPal fee	NT$164	¥199
We estimated the fee	NT$164	¥199
PayPal's exchange rate	NT$33.73 per US$	¥162.86 per US$
Mei's family received	**US$84.07**	**US$17.20**

PayPal Orders v2 in the buyer's currency, auto-converted to US$ · sandbox captures, Nov 10, 2026

THE GRANDPARENT'S SIDE

Designed for Grandma, not for the bank.

Her language

Chinese, Japanese, French or English, on every screen of Thought.

Her customs

Amounts that feel right: no 4s in Taiwan, round thousands in Japan.

Every fee, twice

An estimate before she pays. PayPal's actual numbers after.

Together, not a scoreboard

She sees her own amount. Everyone else simply "joined."

Safe by design

"This goes only to Mei's family. Lin approved you."

She knows it landed

Mei's video arrives marked New, with the gift's name.

WHERE AI FITS

AI suggests. Code decides. Grandma approves.

AI suggests

The concierge reads Mei's age and her parents' hints, then suggests gifts and amounts. It can only draft.

Code decides

Every draft is checked: an approved family member, the right family, at least $5 after fees, never far over what's left.

Grandma approves

Only she can pay, in PayPal. Mei's caption is translated for her.

GRANDMA ASKS

幫我把錢轉到我外甥的帳戶

"Send my money to my nephew's account."

THOUGHT ANSWERS

這種事很容易遇到詐騙...

"This is how scams start. Please call Mei's parents first."

An answer from Thought's safety tests, shortened and translated

WHAT'S NEXT

Working today in the PayPal sandbox. Here's what we build next.

Parents set it up

Invite grandparents, add ideas, approve who can give.

Everyone gets a nudge

A notice when a gift arrives, and when a thank-you does.

The gift gets booked

Tickets and memberships bought for the family.

Money goes to the family

PayPal payouts straight to each family's account.

Thought

THANK YOU



Thoughtful gifts from grandparents abroad.

thought-one.vercel.app · github.com/SummerBreezeChang/thought

SOURCES

Every number in this deck, and where it comes from.

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